CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

DIALYSIS TECHNICIAN IN THE AI ERA

You run the machine that does your patients' kidneys' job — three days a week, every week, for years.

★ **TL;DR — Around $45K median with 6–12 months of training and a hemodialysis certification. The catch: very early shifts, blood and needles all day, and patients whose health slowly declines.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

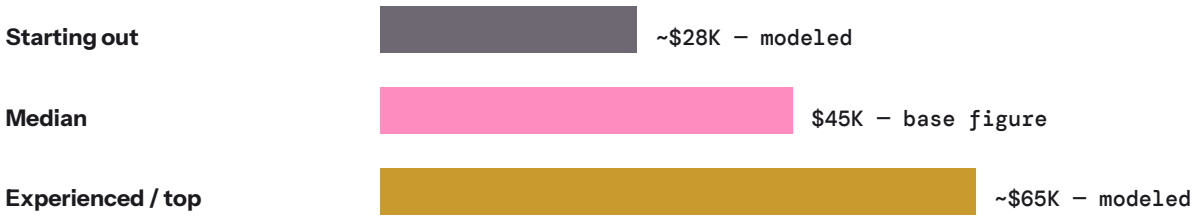
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 6-12 months · AI RISK LOW · CERTIFICATE

- Recurring patients make this the most relationship-heavy tech job in this batch — you know everyone's story.
- Clinics train in-house at scale, so the entry door is unusually practical.
- Machines assist and monitor, but access needles and patient judgment stay manual.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Dialysis Technician is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A DIALYSIS TECHNICIAN ACTUALLY DO?

✓ Set up and test dialysis machines and water systems before each shift

- ✓ Cannulate patients' vascular access and start treatments
- ✓ Monitor vitals and machine parameters through 3–4 hour treatments
- ✓ Document treatments and report changes to the nursing team

Think: a pilot flying the same route with the same passengers — safety in ritual, meaning in familiarity.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Dialysis machines self-monitor and log treatments automatically; remote monitoring flags issues across clinics. Setup, access and the patient remain stubbornly manual.	Machine vigilance plus human vigilance: noticing the patient fading before alarms agree, and managing access sites with your hands. Long hours with the same people build real trust.

⚠ **The emotional math is unusual: you'll love your regulars, and dialysis patients get sicker over years. Clinics know this burns people out — pace your attachment.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Deep, years-long patient relationships ✓ Predictable schedules once you're core staff ✓ Skill mastery is visible daily: your cannulations work or they don't	✗ Shifts can start brutally early ✗ Needles, blood and access emergencies are routine ✗ Watching long-term patients decline is part of the job

Good fit? Precise, patient and relationship-driven — you'll see the same people for years.
Bad fit? Blood makes you faint, or you need fast-moving variety.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — CLINIC TRAINEE + CERTIFICATION	DOOR B — HOSPITAL DIALYSIS UNIT
Get hired by a dialysis provider (the big clinics train in-house) or complete a dialysis tech program, then work supervised treatments while logging hours toward the hemodialysis certification exam (CCHT route).	Hospital dialysis units hire techs into smaller, more acute teams. Fewer seats, sicker patients, broader learning — a strong route if a hospital near you runs an in-house unit.

Smart move: Master cannulation and water-system troubleshooting — the two skills charge nurses protect most. The tech who can do both is never the one cut from the schedule.

Where you land after: Dialysis tech → senior/preceptor tech, clinic leadership tracks — or a springboard into nursing with years of patient experience banked.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
FIND YOUR	START STRUCTURED	BUILD HANDS-ON	LEARN THE	PASS THE	BECOME A

STEP 1 — Find your entry

FREE · TODAY

- List dialysis clinics hiring trainees near you; the big providers train constantly.
- Ask what certification timeline they expect and support.

STEP 2 — Start structured training

FIRST WEEKS

- Kidney basics, machine setup, water treatment and infection control.
- Shadow full treatments before touching a machine alone.

STEP 3 — Build hands-on hours

MONTHS 1-3

- Supervised setups, then cannulation practice on real access sites.
- Every stuck fistula teaches; log them and ask for critique.

STEP 4 — Learn the patient panel

THROUGHOUT

- Study certification material alongside shifts, not after.
- Preceptors' habits become your habits — pick good ones to copy.

STEP 5 — Pass the certification

EXAM FEE · WHEN HOURS ARE MET

- Sit the hemodialysis certification exam once experience requirements are met.
- Certification locks in portability between employers.

STEP 6 — Become a core tech

MONTHS 4-6

- Run your own patient assignments reliably.
- Reliability and calm during alarms define your reputation.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- ☐ Today: list dialysis providers hiring near you and in-house training details.
- ☐ Days 1–30: apply for trainee roles or enroll in a program; CPR/BLS done.

 Days 31–60: training underway — machine setup and water-system study daily.

 Days 61–90: supervised cannulations accumulating; certification study started.

 Day 90: you're treating real patients under supervision, with the certification clock running.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **SAME PATIENTS. REAL RELATIONSHIPS.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.